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Hindustan Project Fails for the Second Time

The Departure of Muqīm and Allotment of Lands

Now that Kābul was in Babur's grip, Muqīm asked for leave to go to Qandahār. He left town on some terms and conditions laid—he was allowed to go to his father (Ẕu'n-nūn) and elder brother (Shāh Beg), along with various household followers, and his valuable assets.

The land of Kābul after Muqīm's departure was being shared between Mīrzās and the guest begs.[1] Ghaznī with its dependencies was given to Jahāngīr Mīrzā. Nāṣir Mīrzā was given the Nangarhār tūmān, Mandrāwar, Nūr valley, Kūnār, Nūr-gal and Chīghān-sarāī. Babur awarded some of the begs, who had been with him in his guerrilla times, villages and fief.

Babur has mentioned in the *Baburnama*: '*Wilāyat khūd hech bīrīlmādī . . .*' This makes it clear that he kept the mainland of Kābul to himself.

Babur wanted to bestow more favours on the guest begs, who were still strangers compared to old servants and Andijānīs. But he made an interesting observation in the *Baburnama*: 'This I have always done whenever Allah has shown me his favour; yet it is remarkable that despite this, people have blamed me constantly as though I had favoured none but old servants and Andijānīs.'

He then cites two proverbs (Turkī and Persian, respectively):[*]

1. What will a foe not say? what enters not into dream?'
2. A town-gate can be shut, a foe's mouth never.

Grain is Levied

Kābul was now full of clans and hordes that had come from Samarkand, Ḥiṣār and Qūndūz.

Babur has mentioned, 'Kābul is a small country; it is also of the sword, not of the pen, to take in money from it for all these tribesmen was impossible. It, therefore, seemed advisable to take in grain, provision for the families of these